

Researchers question AI data centers' 'eye-popping' energy demands

Posted by u/Branch_Out_Now • 0 points • 11 comments

Interesting article on the energy demands of AI and some researchers and consumer advocates who think those demands are overhyped. Here's a small excerpt:

<https://san.com/cc/researchers-question-ai-data-centers-eye-popping-energy-demands/>

In an interview with Straight Arrow News, Koomey described how, in the late 1990s, many people believed that computers would use half of all the electricity produced in the U.S. within a decade or two.

"It turned out that across the board, these claims were vast exaggerations," said Koomey, who has spent his career researching the energy and environmental effects of information technology, including more than two decades as a scientist at the Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory.

Koomey is part of a growing number of researchers and consumer advocates who worry that the power consumption hype is playing out again with AI.

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-09-12 13:14 UTC

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u/No_Station_9831 • 1 points • 2025-09-12 13:10 UTC

La vraie question c'est peut-être moins la quantité d'énergie que son utilité réelle.
Si l'IA est utilisée pour le bien commun, son impact positif peut largement compenser sa consommation.
Tout dépend de ce qu'on en fait.

u/archbid • 1 points • 2025-09-12 03:24 UTC

I suspect that small nuclear is part of the grift

u/Jokong • 1 points • 2025-09-12 10:56 UTC

Robots are next too.

u/ExaminationFuzzy4009 • 0 points • 2025-09-12 00:27 UTC

first glance, this is a piss poor article. cant compare 1990 to 2025.

u/Branch_Out_Now • 1 points • 2025-09-12 00:30 UTC

Worth another glance because the dot com comparison is only the first few paragraphs

u/ExaminationFuzzy4009 • 1 points • 2025-09-12 00:35 UTC

****Skepticism About Forecasts****

- * Researchers warn of “phantom” data centers — projects proposed but never built.
- * this is demand signal - people want to build but cant
- * Utilities often double-count requests, inflating forecasts.
- * demand signal want to build but cant.
- * Think customers want to buy your product but you cannot produce enough
- * Critics recall the dot-com bubble when claims of runaway energy use proved false.
- * weak

u/reddit455 • 1 points • 2025-09-11 23:41 UTC

> many people believed that computers would use half of all the electricity produced in the U.S. within a decade or two.

back then, computers didn't perform manual labor... some portion of food will be replaced by electricity.

****Humanoid Robots for BMW Group Plant Spartanburg.****

[<https://www.bmwgroup.com/en/news/general/2024/humanoid-robots.html>]

(<https://www.bmwgroup.com/en/news/general/2024/humanoid-robots.html>)

****Hyundai unleashes Atlas robots in Georgia plant as part of \$21B US automation push****

[<https://interestingengineering.com/innovation/hyundai-to-deploy-humanoid-atlas-robots>]

(<https://interestingengineering.com/innovation/hyundai-to-deploy-humanoid-atlas-robots>)

u/ethotopia • 2 points • 2025-09-11 23:32 UTC

I think energy and small module reactor stocks are the next big play after oracle tbh.

u/ExaminationFuzzy4009 • 1 points • 2025-09-12 00:26 UTC

natural gas off utility power, hydrogen, nuclear.

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-09-11 23:30 UTC

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